

TCI/BHORUKA GROUP Established 1958

Despite India being seen as a late entrant in the mini-hydel power sector, the group's power plants in Karnataka are producing nearly 100 MW of power

POWERFUL STRIDE

From just one truck in 1958 to one of India's largest integrated supply chain solutions majors, TCI has undergone a metamorphosis. As part of the Bhoruka Group, founded by late Prabhu Dayal Agarwal, the company realised that the relatively low-cost and environment-friendly mini-hydel power sector in India was yet to be explored. In the 1980s, the group became the first private sector company to commission the 18-MW Shivapur hydel plant on the banks of the Tungabhadra river near Hampi in Karnataka.

"It's a powerful accomplishment because big power stations take a long time and a lot of money," says S.N. Agarwal, chairman of the Bhoruka

Group, who is currently supervising more than a dozen power stations producing nearly 100 MW across the state. Mini-hydel power plants can produce energy in remote and hilly areas and they don't need big money or massive paperwork like dams.

Agarwal, also the chairman of the Indian chapter of the International Chamber of Commerce, recently launched a Rs 250-crore edible oil and bio-diesel facility in Australia, the biggest Indian-backed greenfield investment in that part of the continent. With it, he is hoping

to generate at least 75 million litres of bio-diesel to help push the company's green energy initiatives. Apart from supply chain logistics and production of industrial gases, the company has forayed into real estate which includes construction of premium flats in Mumbai and a modern tech park in Bangalore.

Today, 800 power plants across India produce a combined 2,000 MW of power, which is way below the 15,000-MW potential for mini-hydro projects for which both the Centre and the state governments have an array of incentives. Agarwal, who has done an advanced management programme from Harvard, says mini-

hydel projects are the best option for India, considering the large volume of water wastage in the country. After last month's project in Australia, the group is now planning to shift its focus to the neighbouring countries by setting up mini-hydel power plants in Sri Lanka. **by Stephen David**

51,207 MW
is the total hydropower generating capacity anticipated at the end of the 11th Five-Year Plan in India.

"Our big thrust is on green power through mini-hydro projects to ensure a cleaner environment and a better world."

S.N. Agarwal 63, Chairman, Bhoruka Group

